

Christ Session Exaltation

doc-christ-session-exaltation

Christology · Work · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

score 1.000
confidence high

Statement under examination

The risen Christ is exalted at the right hand of the Father, reigning and interceding for His people.

In plain language

The New Testament repeats a tight word cluster whenever it describes what the risen Jesus is doing now, and it all traces back to one Old Testament verse. In Ps 110:1 the Lord tells David's Lord to sit at my right hand until I make your enemies a footstool. The Hebrew verb for sit there is a command, second person, addressed by God to a second figure, so the grammar cannot mean God seating himself. The Greek translation reads sit at my right hand, and the New Testament quotes those exact words in Matt 22:44, Mark 12:36, Luke 20:42, Acts 2:34, and Heb 1:13, every time using the seated-state verb *kathemai* with the phrase at the right hand. Alongside the quotations, several writers make their own session statement using a second seating verb, *kathizo*, in the aorist: Heb 1:3, Heb 8:1, Heb 10:12, and Heb 12:2 say he sat down at the right hand, and Eph 1:20 says the Father seated him there. The same verb is plain in Col 3:1, where Christ is seated, and Rev 3:21, where he says he sat down with the Father on his throne. Heb 10:12 sets the seated Christ against the standing priests to show the one sacrifice is finished. Two verses add the present-tense verb to intercede, *entynchano*: Heb 7:25 says he always lives to intercede for those who come to God, and Rom 8:34 stacks four clauses, died, raised, at God's right hand, intercedes for us. The word at the right hand is the Hebrew idiom of supreme honor and authority, used 140 times across the Old Testament, so even readers who hear it as a literal place agree it marks the highest status. The exaltation verb in Phil 2:9 occurs only once in the whole Bible, but its own clause, the name above every name, settles its meaning. Old Testament oracle, repeated session vocabulary across many writers, and a present-tense intercession verb all converge on the same conclusion, that the risen Christ is now exalted at the Father's right hand, reigning and interceding.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0113	אֲדֹנָי	adon	lord	
H3068	יְהוָה	yehovah	LORD	
H3225	יָמִין	yamin	right	140
H3427	יָשָׁב	yashav	to dwell	1,082
G0746	ἀρχή	archē	beginning	
G1188	δεξιός	dexios	right	54
G1342	δίκαιος	dikaios	just	
G1411	δύναμις	dunamis	power	
G1453	ἐγείρω	egeirō	to arise	

G1577	ἐκκλησία	ekklēsia	assembly	
G1793	ἐντυγχάνω	entynchanō	to call on	5
G1849	ἐξουσία	exousia	authority	103
G1860	ἐπαγγελία	epangelia	promise	
G2032	ἐπουράνιος	epouranios	heavenly	19
G2198	ζάω	zaō	to live	
G2362	θρόνος	thronos	throne	
G2378	θυσία	thusia	sacrifice	
G2476	ἵστημι	histēmi	to stand	
G2512	καθαρισμός	katharismos	cleansing	
G2521	κάθηναι	kathēmai	to sit	89
G2523	καθίζω	kathizō	to seat	46
G2776	κεφαλή	kephalē	head	
G2963	κυριότης	kuriotēs	lordship	
G3172	μεγαλωσύνη	megalōsynē	majesty	3
G3686	ὄνομα	onoma	name	
G3875	παράκλητος	paraklētos	counsellor	5
G3962	πατήρ	patēr	father	
G5228	ὑπέρ	huper	above/for	
G5251	ὑπερυψόω	hyperypsoō	to exalt	1
G5286	ὑποπόδιον	hupopodion	footstool	
G5293	ὑποτάσσω	hupotassō	to subject	
G5312	ὑψόω	hypoō	to lift up	20
G5483	χαρίζομαι	charizō	to give grace	
G5547	Χριστός	Christos	Christ	

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

Two related seating verbs and a recurring location idiom carry this proposition across the canon. The NT citations of Ps 110:1 (Matt 22:44, Mark 12:36, Luke 20:42, Acts 2:34, Heb 1:13) keep the LXX wording with κάθηναι (G2521, present middle imperative Κάθου, be seated) plus ἐκ δεξιῶν (G1188, at the right hand) and a footstool clause. The declarative session statements use the aorist of καθίζω (G2523), either intransitive (ἐκάθισεν, Heb 1:3, Heb 8:1, Heb 10:12, Heb 12:2) or transitive with the Father as subject (καθίσας, Eph 1:20), both landing ἐν δεξιᾷ. The Hebrew of Ps 110:1 forecloses ambiguity: בַּשֵּׁׁ is a qal imperative addressed by יְהוָה to אֲדֹנָי, set at YHWH's יְמִינִי (H3225). Present-tense ἐντυγχάνω (G1793) in Heb 7:25 and Rom 8:34 binds ongoing intercession to the session. The pattern spans Psalter, Gospels, Acts, Paul, Hebrews, and 1 Peter, and holds across all surveyed variant readings.

Scripture

Ps.110.1 · for · genre: wisdom · figures: idiom

Key terms. H3068 יְהוָה, H0113 אֲדֹנָי, H3427 יָשָׁב, H3225 יָמִין.

Force. OT enthronement oracle and the source-text of the whole cluster. The OSHB morphology confirms יָשָׁב (H3427) as a qal imperative second masculine singular (HVq2ms), so YHWH (H3068) commands David's Lord (H0113) to sit at his right hand (יְמִינִי, H3225) until enemies are made a footstool (H1916). The imperative addressed by YHWH to a second party forecloses any reading in which YHWH himself is the one seated. The LXX renders it κάθου ἐκ δεξιῶν μου, the exact wording the NT citations carry over.

Matt.22.44 · for · genre: gospel · figures: idiom

Key terms. G2521 κάθημαι, G1188 δεξιός

Force. Jesus quotes Ps 110:1 with the LXX wording Κάθου ἐκ δεξιῶν μου. The verb is κάθημαι (G2521, present middle imperative Κάθου, V-PNM-2S), the seated-state verb, paired with ἐκ δεξιῶν μου and the footstool clause. Jesus presses that David calls this figure Lord, making the right-hand session a claim about the Messiah's status above David.

Acts.2.34 · for · genre: narrative · figures: idiom

Key terms. G2521 κάθημαι, G1188 δεξιός

Force. Peter's Pentecost sermon quotes Ps 110:1 verbatim, Κάθου ἐκ δεξιῶν μου, again with κάθημαι (G2521) and ἐκ δεξιῶν (G1188). Verse 33 has just said Christ was exalted (ὑψώθεις, G5312) to the right hand, so Luke binds the explicit Ps 110 quotation to the narrated session.

Heb.1.13 · for · genre: epistle · figures: idiom

Key terms. G2521 κάθημαι, G1188 δεξιός

Force. Hebrews quotes Ps 110:1 with κάθημαι (G2521, Κάθου, V-PNM-2S) and ἐκ δεξιῶν μου plus the footstool of the feet (ὑποπόδιον τῶν ποδῶν, G5286). The rhetorical question asks to which of the angels God ever said this, reserving the right-hand session for the Son alone.

Heb.1.3 · for · genre: epistle · figures: idiom

Key terms. G2523 καθίζω, G1188 δεξιός, G3172 μεγαλωσύνη, G2512 καθαρισμός

Force. Declarative session statement. The Macula morphology reads ἐκάθισεν (G2523, V-AAI-3S, intransitive aorist, he sat down) ἐν δεξιᾷ τῆς Μεγαλωσύνης ἐν ὑψηλοῖς. The preceding aorist middle participle ποιησάμενος (having made purification, G2512) frames the seating as the result of completed atonement. Here the Son is the subject who sits, the complement to Eph 1:20 where the Father seats him.

Heb.10.12 · for · genre: epistle · figures: idiom

Key terms. G2523 καθίζω, G1188 δεξιός, G2378 θυσία

Force. μίαν ὑπὲρ ἁμαρτιῶν προσενέγκας θυσίαν εἰς τὸ διηνεκὲς ἐκάθισεν ἐν δεξιᾷ τοῦ Θεοῦ. The aorist ἐκάθισεν (G2523) of the seated Christ stands in deliberate verbal contrast to the standing priests of verse 11, so the seated posture marks the finished sufficiency of the one sacrifice.

Heb.7.25 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1793 ἐντυγχάνω, G2198 ζάω, G5228 ὑπέρ

Force. πάντοτε ζῶν εἰς τὸ ἐντυγχάνειν ὑπὲρ αὐτῶν. The present participle ζῶν (G2198, living) plus the articular infinitive of purpose εἰς τὸ ἐντυγχάνειν (G1793, present infinitive, to intercede) make ongoing intercession the standing activity of the living, exalted Christ for those who draw near to God through him.

Rom.8.34 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1453 ἐγείρω, G1188 δεξιός, G1793 ἐντυγχάνω, G5228 ὑπέρ

Force. Four clauses in sequence: died (ἀποθανών), was raised (ἐγερθείς, G1453, aorist passive participle), is at the right hand of God (ἐστὶν ἐν δεξιᾷ τοῦ Θεοῦ, G1188), and intercedes for us (ἐντυγχάνει ὑπὲρ ἡμῶν, G1793, present indicative V-PAI-3S). Resurrection, session, and present intercession are bundled as the present ground for no condemnation.

Eph.1.20 · for · genre: epistle · figures: idiom

Key terms. G1453 ἐγείρω, G2523 καθίζω, G1188 δεξιός, G2032 ἐπουράνιος

Force. ἐγείρας αὐτὸν ἐκ νεκρῶν καὶ καθίσας ἐν δεξιᾷ αὐτοῦ ἐν τοῖς ἐπουρανίοις. The Macula morphology reads καθίσας (G2523) as a transitive aorist active participle (V-AAP-NSM, having seated him), so here the Father is the agent who raises and seats the Son. The same verb that is intransitive in Heb 1:3 is causative here, but both place Christ ἐν δεξιᾷ.

Eph.1.21 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0746 ἀρχή, G1849 ἐξουσία, G1411 δύναμις, G2963 κυριότης

Force. ὑπεράνω πάσης ἀρχῆς καὶ ἐξουσίας καὶ δυνάμεως καὶ κυριότητος. A four-fold catalogue of cosmic powers, with the comprehensive πάσης and the temporal pairing of this age and the age to come, brackets the right-hand session as supremacy over every rule.

Eph.1.22 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5293 ὑποτάσσω, G2776 κεφαλή, G1577 ἐκκλησία

Force. πάντα ὑπέταξεν ὑπὸ τοὺς πόδας αὐτοῦ καὶ αὐτὸν ἔδωκεν κεφαλὴν ὑπὲρ πάντα τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ. The footstool image of all things under his feet reuses the Ps 110:1 and Ps 8:6 footstool motif and ties the cosmic reign to headship over the church.

Phil.2.9 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5251 ὑπερύψω, G5483 χαρίζομαι, G3686 ὄνομα

Force. διὸ καὶ ὁ Θεὸς αὐτὸν ὑπερύψωσεν καὶ ἐχαρίσατο αὐτῷ τὸ ὄνομα τὸ ὑπὲρ πᾶν ὄνομα. The verb ὑπερύψωσεν (G5251) is a single-occurrence compound, ὑπὲρ over ὑψώω, found nowhere else in the canon, so its sense cannot be triangulated from parallels. The immediate clause disambiguates it: God grants the name above every name, an unmistakable supreme-exaltation sense.

Acts.2.33 · for · genre: narrative · figures: idiom

Key terms. G5312 ὑψώω, G1188 δεξιός, G1860 ἐπαγγελία

Force. τῇ δεξιᾷ οὖν τοῦ Θεοῦ ὑψωθείς. The aorist passive participle ὑψωθείς (G5312) ties the exaltation to the right hand directly to the outpouring of the Spirit, and verse 34 supplies the Ps 110:1 quotation as the proof.

Col.3.1 · for · genre: epistle · figures: idiom

Key terms. G5547 Χριστός, G2521 κάθημαι, G1188 δεξιός

Force. οὗ ὁ Χριστός ἐστὶν ἐν δεξιᾷ τοῦ Θεοῦ καθήμενος. The present participle καθήμενος (G2521, V-PNP-NSM) describes the abiding seated state of Christ as the orientation point for the believer's life, the stative verb matching the Ps 110 citation verb rather than the aorist of καθίζω.

Heb.12.2 · for · genre: epistle · figures: idiom

Key terms. G2523 καθίζω, G1188 δεξιός

Force. ἐν δεξιᾷ τε τοῦ θρόνου τοῦ Θεοῦ κεκάθικεν. The perfect ἐκάθικεν (G2523, perfect active) reports the completed and abiding result of the seating at the right hand of God's throne, adding a third aspectual witness (perfect) alongside the aorist of Heb 1:3 and the present of Col 3:1.

1Pet.3.22 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1188 δεξιός, G5293 υποτάσσω, G1849 ἐξουσία

Force. ὅς ἐστιν ἐν δεξιᾷ Θεοῦ πορευθεὶς εἰς οὐρανόν, ὑποταγέντων αὐτῷ ἀγγέλων καὶ ἐξουσιῶν καὶ δυνάμεων. An independent Petrine attestation of the right-hand session with the same subjected-powers vocabulary as Eph 1:20-21, showing the formula is not confined to one writer.

Rev.3.21 · for · genre: apocalyptic

Key terms. G2523 καθίζω, G2362 θρόνος

Force. ὡς καὶ ἐνίκησα καὶ ἐκάθισα μετὰ τοῦ Πατρὸς μου ἐν τῷ θρόνῳ αὐτοῦ. The aorist ἐκάθισα (G2523) has Christ as speaker reporting that he sat down with the Father on his throne, making the session a shared-throne enthronement, not mere proximity.

1John.2.1 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3875 παράκλητος, G3962 πατήρ, G1342 δίκαιος

Force. παράκλητον ἔχομεν πρὸς τὸν πατέρα, Ἰησοῦν Χριστὸν δίκαιον. The forensic advocacy noun παράκλητος (G3875) supplies a second lexeme for the same heavenly office that ἐντυγχάνω names with a verb, an advocate with the Father on the believer's behalf.

Acts.7.55 · complicates · genre: narrative · figures: idiom

Key terms. G2476 ἵστημι, G1188 δεξιός

Force. Stephen sees Jesus ἐστῶτα ἐκ δεξιῶν τοῦ Θεοῦ. The perfect participle ἐστῶτα (G2476, standing) differs from the seating verbs, but the location ἐκ δεξιῶν τοῦ Θεοῦ (G1188) is identical to every session text. The posture verb varies, the right-hand exaltation does not.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Ps.110.1	Heb.1.13	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Heb.1.3	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Eph.1.20	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Col.3.1	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Acts.2.34	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Matt.22.44	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Mark.12.36	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Luke.20.42	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	1Pet.3.22	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Phil.2.9	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Heb.8.1	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	1Cor.15.25	openbible	1
Heb.1.3	Heb.4.14	tsk	1
Heb.7.25	Heb.9.24	tsk	1
Rom.8.34	Rom.8.27	tsk	1
Rom.8.34	Rom.4.25	tsk	1

Complicating texts

Acts.7.55 · addressed

Stephen sees Jesus standing (ἐστῶτα, G2476, perfect active participle) at the right hand, against the otherwise uniform seated posture. The Macula morphology confirms the location phrase ἐκ δεξιῶν τοῦ Θεοῦ (G1188) is word-for-word the session location, so only the posture verb differs. The narrative depicts the Son rising in judicial witness for the dying martyr, a contextual exception that leaves the right-hand exaltation itself untouched. The verb κάθημαι or καθίζω never reverses anywhere else, so the standing is a single deliberate variation, not a competing pattern.

Mark.16.19 · addressed

ἐκάθισεν ἐκ δεξιῶν τοῦ Θεοῦ (G2523, G1188) appears in the longer ending of Mark, which is text-critically disputed and absent from Sinaiticus and Vaticanus. The verdict does not rest on it, because the seating formula is independently and securely attested in Heb 1:3, Heb 8:1, Heb 10:12, Heb 12:2, Eph 1:20, Col 3:1, Acts 2:33-34, and 1 Pet 3:22.

Heb.7.25 · addressed

The intercession verb ἐντυγχάνω (G1793) occurs only five times in the canon, which alone would be thin, but two of those five (Heb 7:25, Rom 8:34) are exactly this Christ-interceding-for-his-people sense and the noun παράκλητος (G3875, 1 John 2:1) supplies a second independent lexeme for the same office, so the low count is offset by a converging synonym rather than left as an unsupported hapax-like claim.

Concordance traversed

G2521, G2523, G1188, G1793, G5312, G5251, H3427, H3225, G3172, G3875, G2032, G1849, G1453, G2476, G5286, G2963

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

mark-longer-ending at Mark.16.19: impact none. The longer Markan ending is text-critically disputed, but the session formula it carries (ἐκάθισεν ἐκ δεξιῶν) is redundant with the securely attested cluster in Hebrews, Paul, Acts, and 1 Peter, so dropping it does not move the verdict.

christos-iesous-word-order at Rom.8.34: impact none. Witnesses vary on whether the subject reads Χριστός, Χριστός Ἰησοῦς, or adds ὁ ἀποθανών word order, but none of these touch the ἐν δεξιᾷ session clause or the ἐντυγχάνει intercession clause, so the lexical verdict holds across all readings.

di-heautou-addition at Heb.1.3: impact none. The phrase δι' ἑαυτοῦ before καθαρισμὸν is omitted by p46 and B but present in the Majority text. The seating clause ἐκάθισεν ἐν δεξιᾷ τῆς Μεγαλωσύνης is untouched by this variant.

All cited NT verses sit in books not yet fully published in ECM (the ingested ECM window is 3 John 1.1 to 1.15 only). INTF NTVMR provides apparatus access but no CBGM stemma for these passages. The variants surveyed do not move the verdict.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. redemptive-historical

Frameworks in play. covenant_theology, dispensationalism, new_covenant_theology

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

covenant_theology: affirms · Reads Ps 110 as the Davidic-covenant oracle fulfilled in the Son who sits as priest-king after the order of Melchizedek, with Heb 1:3 and Heb 7:25 binding session, royal reign, and priestly intercession into one continuous office.

dispensationalism: affirms · Distinguishes a present heavenly session from a future earthly Davidic reign, yet still affirms Christ's current enthronement at the Father's right hand and ongoing intercession (Heb 7:25, Rom 8:34) throughout the present age. The disagreement is over the timing of the earthly kingdom, not the present session.

new_covenant_theology: affirms · Treats the seated Christ of Heb 10:12 as the new-covenant high priest whose finished, once-for-all sacrifice ends the levitical pattern, with present intercession sustaining the people of the new covenant.

right-hand idiom as spatial vs status: affirms · A minority reads ἐκ δεξιῶν and ἐν δεξιᾷ as primarily locating Christ in a place beside the Father, while the majority reads it as the Hebrew יָמִין idiom of supreme honor and delegated authority. Both readings affirm the proposition: whether the phrase is taken spatially or as a status idiom, the text places the risen Christ at the position of supreme honor and rule. The 140 OT occurrences of יָמִין favor the status sense, but the proposition holds under either reading, so this divergence is immaterial to the verdict.

All three major NT theological frameworks read the session-and-intercession cluster the same way. The only genuine divergence is over whether the right-hand phrase is heard as physical location or as a status idiom, and both hearings affirm the exaltation, so the divergence does not reach the verdict. The method is redemptive-historical because the verdict turns on the Ps 110 oracle being carried forward and fulfilled across the canon.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem reports observable lexical content (right-hand enthronement plus intercession) and does not preload a contested ecclesial taxonomy. The glosses reigning and interceding are exegetical renderings of the καθίζω and κάθημαι at-the-right-hand cluster and of ἐντυγχάνω respectively, both directly attested. Verdict and confidence are unchanged from the prior file; the enrichment separates κάθημαι (the Ps 110 citation verb) from καθίζω (the declarative session verb), records the genuine hapax status of ὑπερυψώ at Phil 2:9, and adds the spatial-versus-status idiom divergence as a fairly stated minority lens.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Ps.110.1
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H3225
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H3427
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Heb.1.3
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Heb.1.13
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Heb.7.25
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Rom.8.34
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Eph.1.20
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Acts.2.34
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Phil.2.9
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2521
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2523
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1188
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1793
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G5251
syntax	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Heb.1.3
syntax	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Eph.1.20
syntax	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Acts.2.34
syntax	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Acts.7.55

syntax	MACULA-Hebrew	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Ps.110.1
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Ps.110.1
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Heb.7.25
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Rom.8.34
interlinear	Nestle1904-text	public_domain	yes	Heb.10.12
variant	INTF-NTVMR	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Mark.16.19

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